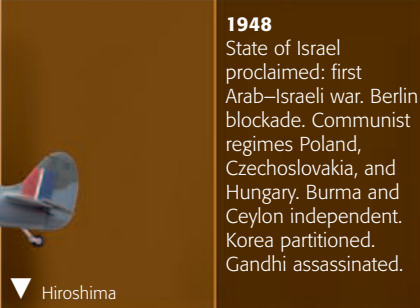
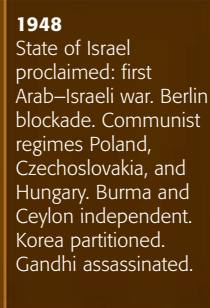
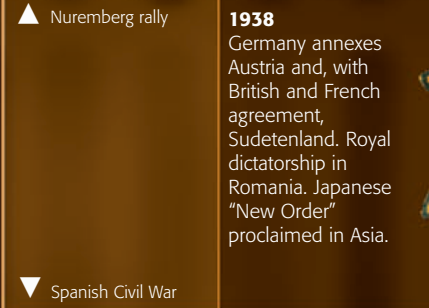
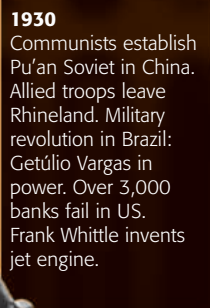
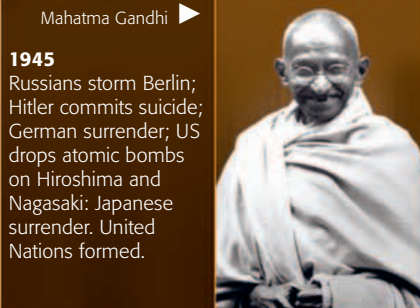


World War I, far from being the “war to end all wars,” not only led to the political and economic turmoil that engulfed Europe in the 1920s and 1930s, but also sparked the Russian Revolution, ushering in the world’s first communist state, the USSR. This was the beginning of an ideological confrontation that lasted until 1991. World War II, though in

part a consequence of the Great Depression, was also directly spawned. It proved even more bloody, with a final death toll of more than 50 million. It left Europe prostrate, and directly contributed to decolonization across Africa, the Middle East, and Southeast Asia. In some regions an era of sustained economic growth followed the conflict.

1930		1935		1940		1945		»	
									
1932 Famines in USSR leave around five million dead. Iraq gains independence. Kingdom of Saudi Arabia proclaimed. Chaco War: Bolivian claims to northern Paraguay. Disarmament conference in Geneva.		1938 Germany annexes Austria and, with British and French agreement, Sudetenland. Royal dictatorship in Romania. Japanese “New Order” proclaimed in Asia.		1942 Battle of Midway: US repulses Japanese carrier fleet; German invasion of USSR stalls at Stalingrad; Axis forces defeated at El Alamein; US invades North Africa; killings begin at Auschwitz.		1948 State of Israel proclaimed: first Arab–Israeli war. Berlin blockade. Communist regimes Poland, Czechoslovakia, and Hungary. Burma and Ceylon independent. Korea partitioned. Gandhi assassinated.			
▲ Depression in the US 1933 Hitler appointed chancellor in Germany. Dollfuss establishes authoritarian rule in Austria. Communist Party purged in USSR. Roosevelt president of US: launches “New Deal.” World Economic Conference in London.		▲ Nuremberg rally ▼ Spanish Civil War		▲ Spitfire Mk V 1942 Battle of Midway: US repulses Japanese carrier fleet; German invasion of USSR stalls at Stalingrad; Axis forces defeated at El Alamein; US invades North Africa; killings begin at Auschwitz.					
1930 Communists establish Pu’an Soviet in China. Allied troops leave Rhineland. Military revolution in Brazil: Getúlio Vargas in power. Over 3,000 banks fail in US. Frank Whittle invents jet engine.				▲ Gold “Jew” star 1940 German forces conquer Denmark, Norway, Holland, Luxembourg, Belgium, and France; Italy declares war on Britain and France; Battle of Britain; Japan allied with Germany and Italy.		Mahatma Gandhi ▶ 1945 Russians storm Berlin; Hitler commits suicide; German surrender; US drops atomic bombs on Hiroshima and Nagasaki; Japanese surrender. United Nations formed.			
		1936 “Great Terror” in USSR: start of show trials and purges. Spanish Civil War begins. Germany remilitarizes Rhineland. Anti-Comintern Pact between Germany and Japan. ◀ Hitler Soviet secret police poster ▶		1941 German invasion of USSR; “Final Solution” ordered; Japan attacks Pearl Harbor: US enters war on Allied side; Japan invades Malaya, Burma, Philippines, and Dutch East Indies.		1944 900-day siege of Leningrad lifted. D-Day landings: second front in France; Paris and Brussels liberated; Battle of the Bulge: German offensive checked; Germans fire V2 rockets at London. ▼ Pearl Harbor			
		1937 Italy resigns from League of Nations; joins anti-Comintern Pact. US Neutrality Act passes into law. Sino-Japanese war: Japan sacks Nanking. Anti-French uprising in Tunisia. Authoritarian “New State,” Brazil.		1941 German invasion of USSR; “Final Solution” ordered; Japan attacks Pearl Harbor: US enters war on Allied side; Japan invades Malaya, Burma, Philippines, and Dutch East Indies.		1944 900-day siege of Leningrad lifted. D-Day landings: second front in France; Paris and Brussels liberated; Battle of the Bulge: German offensive checked; Germans fire V2 rockets at London. ▼ Pearl Harbor			
		1939 Germany advances into Czechoslovakia. Franco imposes right-wing dictatorship in Spain. German–Soviet Non-Aggression Pact. Germany invades Poland: Britain and France declare war.				1947 India and Pakistan independent: widespread violence. US sponsors Marshall Plan. UN agrees partition of Palestine. GATT agreed, US. Sound barrier broken in US.		▲ Chairman Mao 1949 Mao’s Communists victorious in Chinese civil war. East and West Germany established, the former as part of the Communist Bloc. NATO formed. USSR acquires atomic bomb.	